

8 July 2025

Alison Douglass
alison.douglass1@gmail.com

cc:
Will Doughty
will.doughty@kaikoura.govt.nz

REF: OIA-18605

Dear Alison

Request made under the Official Information Act 1982

Thank you for your email of 5 June 2024 to Will Doughty, Chief Executive Officer for Kaikoura District Council, requesting information about the Glen Alton/Clarence Bridge under the Official Information Act 1982 (the Act).

The following aspects of your request were transferred to NZ Transport Agency Waka Kotahi (NZTA) on 9 June 2025 for response:

Firstly, we wish to receive NZTA's decision and the reasons for declining funding.... If the funding was/is to be declined, we expect would have been consulted on any pending decision and to be informed of the reasons in light of this extensive history.

...

If the revised roading estimate from your contractor was or is an issue – can't that be reviewed and vided? Why could a decision from NZTA not be suspended pending any further information or revisions required?

...

We seek full disclosure of the decision-making process, including the Minutes and reasons from both KDC NZTA

For your convenience I have numbered these and responded to each part in turn below.

- 1. Firstly, we wish to receive NZTA's decision and the reasons for declining funding.... If the funding was/is to be declined, we expect would have been consulted on any pending decision and to be informed of the reasons in light of this extensive history.**

The following document falls within scope of your request and is enclosed:

- Attachment 1 – ID Committee_KDC Clarence River April 2025

I can confirm the Board approved the recommendations outlined in the attached document.

Certain information has been withheld from Attachment 1 under section 9(2)(g)(i) to maintain the effective conduct of public affairs through the free and frank expression of opinions by or between or to Ministers of the Crown or members of an organisation or officers and employees of any department or organisation in the course of their duty.

Please note, the recommendation in Attachment 1 is intended to be read in the context of the information set out in it, in that given the lack of progress there is no need to consider the funding increase. Should progress be made in the future, it remains open for KDC to apply for funding.

2. If the revised roading estimate from your contractor was or is an issue – can't that be reviewed and vided? Why could a decision from NZTA not be suspended pending any further information or revisions required?

The NZTA Board decision was taken on the basis that there had been no progress for 9 years and no immediate signs of progress in the future. While cost was one element, there were land issues and uncertainty around lwi support that were the main concerns.

Officers of NZTA would have considered a funding increase and extension of time if there had been demonstrable progress as advised to the KDC in December 2024.

3. We seek full disclosure of the decision-making process, including the Minutes and reasons from both KDC NZTA

Please refer to my response to question 1 for NZTA's decision making process.

Under section 28 of the Act, you have the right to ask the Ombudsman to review my decision to withhold some information from this request. The contact details for the Ombudsman can be located at www.ombudsman.parliament.nz.

If you would like to discuss this reply with NZTA, please contact Ministerial Services, by email at official.correspondence@nzta.govt.nz.

Yours sincerely



Jackie Smith
Manager Ministerial Services